THE ILLUSTRATED POLICE NEWS.

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The Illustrated Police News.

SATURDAY, AUGUST 18, 1883.

THE sun, if not the stars in their courses, fought against the historians at Coventry last week. The "Lineal Descendant of Leofric and Godiva," who wrote to the *Times* to protest against the annual custom which takes grotesque liberties with the pious memory of his illustrious ancestors, will no doubt resent, as an additional grievance, the gay sunshine which smiled upon the motley processional groups. It is no doubt distressing to the well-regulated archæological mind that the people of Coventry should prefer the amusement of gazing upon a sort of provincial Lord Mayor's Show—with a young lady in flesh-coloured tights as the central attraction instead of a chief magistrate—to all the elaborate and convincing teachings of Mr. E. A. Freeman and the other erudite persons who have proved the story is a myth, and that Peeping Tom is an anachronism. Fortunately for the lovers of such popular displays as Coventry witnessed on Monday, their promoters are not generally much disturbed by the existence of anachronisms—as witness the presence in this the latest of the Godiva celebrations of several of the famous trade processions in close proximity to the mediæval armour-clad brewers and labourers who represented the retainers of the Mercian earl. Let us hope that the righteous indignation of the archæologists may be appeased, and that even the wrath of the injured descendant of Leofric and Godiva may be assuaged by the consideration that the people of Coventry have enjoyed a bright holiday, and that the innocence of their enjoyment—notwithstanding their defiance of Historical Truth—has been as perfect as is compatible with the scantity of the attire of Godiva's representative. We have too few out-door pageants in England, and in accordance with the catholicity of Sheridan's sentiment, when he warranted that the name of any lady would "prove an excuse for the glass," it may surely be granted that the Godiva legend, distorted though it may be, forms a sufficient excuse for the organisation of a gay cavalcade through the picturesque streets of an ancient English city.

ASSAULT ON A WOMAN.

[SUBJECT OF ILLUSTRATION.]

AT Marylebone Police-court Walter Albrow, nineteen, a labourer, was charged with committing a violent and unprovoked assault on Elizabeth Carr, of 40, Fleet-road, Hampstead, by striking her on the head with a glass bottle. The evidence was to the effect that on Saturday night the accused went to the house of the prosecutrix. On going to the door the latter saw the prisoner and her little boy quarrelling, and Albrow struck her violently upon the head with a bottle, causing her to faint. He was about to strike her a second time when a person who happened to be passing prevented him. Mr. De Rutzen passed sentence of six months' imprisonment with hard labour.

CLEVER RESCUE BY HANLAN.

[SUBJECT OF ILLUSTRATION.]

EDWARD HANLAN, the oarsman, who arrived in New York on Saturday, July 21, was the central figure of an exciting episode on the Haarlem River next day. About noon four young men were on the river in a Whitehall boat. When opposite the Metropolitan Boat Club house their antics caused the boat to capsize, and they were precipitated into the water. Hanlan, who was the guest of the Metropolitan Club, had been swimming from the float outside the house, and had jumped into a gig in order to dive from it, when the cries of the men in the water attracted his attention. Seating himself, he grasped a pair of oars, and a few of his long, powerful strokes brought him alongside the men, who at the time were nearly exhausted, and on the point of going under. They clutched at the outriggers of the cranky craft, and in their excitement endeavoured to clamber into it. It required all Hanlan's exertions to keep them from capsizing the boat. He however warned them that if they did not keep cool their only chance would be lost, and he told them to hold on quietly to the bulwarks of the boat and he would tow them ashore. They did so, and he had pulled them nearly to the boathouse when a number of other and larger boats put off, and the men, who were completely exhausted, were pulled into them. They soon recovered, and made their disappearance without thanking their rescuer or giving their names.

NARROW ESCAPE OF BALLOONISTS.

[SUBJECT OF ILLUSTRATION.]

ON Monday evening a special train of "empties," which left Charing-cross at 5.55 to pick up returning excursionists from Gravesend, had some extraordinary experiences, such as perhaps have hardly ever occurred to a train on a single journey. On leaving Dartford, where some passengers were taken up, the train was proceeding towards Greenhithe, when the driver observed on the line a donkey, which had strayed from an adjoining field. An endeavour was made to stop the train before the animal was reached, but without success, and the poor beast was knocked down and dragged along by the firebox of the engine. The train was stopped, and with great difficulty the body of the animal, which was killed, was extricated from beneath the engine. While this was in progress, a balloon called the "Sunbeam," supposed to come either from Sydenham or Tunbridge Wells, passed over the line, going in the direction of Northfleet. The two aeronauts in the car were observed to be short of gas, and were throwing out ballast, but notwithstanding this, the balloon descended slowly, and when some distance ahead of the train, was, to the horror of the passengers, seen to drop suddenly into the railway cutting two or three hundred yards only in advance of the approaching train. The alarm whistle was sounded, and the brakes put on, and as the balloon dragged the car and its occupants over the down line there seemed nothing but certain death for them; but suddenly the inflated monster, now swaying about wildly, took a sudden upward flight, and, dragging the car clear of the line, fell into an adjoining field just when the train was within a hundred yards of the spot. The escape was marvellous.

SAD BOATING ACCIDENT—SKEGNESS.

[SUBJECT OF ILLUSTRATION.]

A SAD boating accident has occurred at Skegness, a popular watering place on the Lincolnshire coast of the Wash, by which it is feared at least eight or ten persons have lost their lives. On Saturday a large number of excursionists from Sheffield and Nottingham visited the place, and in the afternoon a number arranged to have a sail. As it was low water, the steamer which gave the "sea trips" could not get close to the pier, and a boat was engaged to carry the passengers from the landing stage to the vessel, a distance of about 150 yards. This boat was stated to be able to accommodate about ten persons, but when it started for the steamer there were in it fifteen or sixteen persons, including two or three women. The little craft was so heavily laden that the sides seemed to be only about four inches about the water. It had proceeded only a short distance when several of the passengers, finding that the water was coming in, requested the boatman to take them back to the landing place. It is reported that he merely replied, "Oh, you're all right." He continued his course, but when about seventy yards from the steamer the boat capsized, and the whole of the party were thrown into the water, which at that point was eight or nine feet deep. Many of those on the pier witnessed the occurrence, and did all in their power to assist in the work of rescue, but this seems to have been made difficult from the arrangements of the place. The unfortunate excursionists who had been immersed in the sea were struggling for their lives, whilst those on shore could not give them succour. Eight or ten persons who were in the boat are missing, and it is supposed that they have been drowned. Most of them belong to Nottingham.

On Saturday, at the Worship-street Police-court, Timothy Griffin, seventeen, of Romford-street, Whitechapel, was brought up in custody charged with having stolen £30 in gold, the money of his employer, Henry M'Stay, a tarpaulin manufacturer, in business off Commercial-road. The prisoner now pleaded guilty, admitting that he had collected £30 and absconded. He spent the money, and then gave himself up. Mr. Bushby sentenced him to six weeks' imprisonment.

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EXECUTION AT DURHAM—SHOCKING SCENE ON THE SCAFFOLD.

[SUBJECT OF ILLUSTRATION.]

AT eight o'clock on Monday morning, last week, James Burton, thirty-three, sailor, was executed in her Majesty's Prison at Durham. Unfortunately, as the drop fell, an accident occurred which caused a shocking scene to be witnessed. Burton was convicted at the last Durham Assizes of the murder of Elizabeth Sharpe, aged eighteen years, at Tunstall Cutting, near Sunderland, under circumstances of great brutality. The girl, whom he had married, refused to live with him, and took service, stating that his wife was alive. Prisoner was the last person seen with her an hour before she was found murdered, with a heap of stones piled on her head. The culprit was up and dressed shortly after six o'clock on Monday morning, and looked wearied and downcast. He was brought into the pinioning room at a few minutes to eight o'clock, and was met by Marwood, the executioner. While adjusting the body-strap the culprit said, "Lord have mercy on my soul!" These were all the words he uttered, and the procession was formed to the scaffold, the culprit being supported by Marwood and two warders, the rear being brought up by the chaplain, reading the burial service for the dead, the gaol officials, and three representatives of the press. The culprit walked firmly to the scaffold, but was ghastly white. He cast a hurried look around just before the white cap was adjusted. Just as Marwood stepped back to draw the bolt the culprit seemed to faint, and after the drop gave way a shocking scene followed. The rope got entangled under the culprit's arm, and partly displaced the rope around his neck. Marwood at once seized the rope, and then dragged the unfortunate culprit by the neck out of the pit, placing him in a sitting posture by the side of the pit, and disentangled the rope. Having got it right, Marwood raised the man with his own arms and dropped him into the pit. The body swayed to and fro violently for a minute or two, and then all was over.

An inquest was held on the body of Burton, before Mr. Coroner Graham. On the body being viewed, the features were much discoloured. Mr. William Boyd, surgeon, who was present at the execution that morning, gave evidence as to the occurrence, and said death was caused from strangulation by hanging. He added that Burton appeared to faint when the drop was about to fall, and, swerving to one side, the rope caught under his arm. Other witnesses having been called, William Marwood, who had been sent for at the request of the jury, was sworn. He said he was a shoemaker, residing at Horncastle, in Lincolnshire, but for the past eleven years had occupied the position of public executioner for Great Britain and Ireland. He was engaged by the sheriff of the county to execute James Burton, and arrived at the gaol at seven o'clock that morning. He did not see Burton till five minutes to eight o'clock. At seven o'clock that morning he had all ready for the execution, and had the rope placed in position. The executioner then, at the request of the coroner, produced the rope. At the end beside the noose there were marks of blood, notwithstanding the fact that it had been carefully wiped. The full length of the rope was 12 ft. It was ⅝ in. in diameter, 2⅜ in. in circumference, and was made of the best hemp. The executioner, in answer to further inquiries, said he determined on the length of the drop to be given by the height, weight, and strength of the person to be hanged. He had not previously seen the culprit in the present instance, but he sometimes did. In explanation of the accident the witness said the man was in a fainting condition, was falling over and had to be supported. Owing to his being in that fainting condition the rope caught his left elbow and became entangled. Witness then added: I then raised him and removed the rope from the elbow. He was raised out of the pit altogether by myself. He was put on the edge of the pit whilst I disentangled the rope, and then I dropped him into the pit again. It was weakness which caused him to faint away. For the future it would be better if two planks were placed across the pit for a warder to stand on each side of the culprit, and support him should he require it, and to prevent the rope from getting entangled. It would be better if that was done. A juror: How long was it before he was pushed off the second time?—All was over in four minutes from beginning to end. He dropped eight feet. The coroner, in summing up the evidence, said that whatever reports were in circulation respecting the unhappy affair the jury had the satisfaction of knowing the inquiry had been a most exhaustive one, and that they had all the facts of the case before them. The jury then returned a verdict that judgment of death had been carried into effect upon James Burton, such death being caused by hanging or strangulation.

CONFESSION OF THE CRIME.

James Burton has left behind him the following full confession of his crime to the parents of the girl, Elizabeth Sharpe, whom it was alleged he had bigamously married:—"Dear Father and Mother,—I now take up the painful task to let you know that on May 8 poor Elizabeth, my wife and your daughter, was a heavy sufferer on the railway between Tunstall and Silksworth. I put my hand out to give her a note that she dropped, and she screamed out and poked me in the chest with her umbrella, and said, 'My brother Henry is up there,' and I said, 'I don't care for your brother Henry when I do the thing that is right towards ye.' I started crying, and she said, 'I will swear your life away, for I mean to do it when I get to my father's; there are plenty there waiting for you.' I put my hand against her side to see if she was vexed, or to try if she was in earnest, and she poked me a second time with the umbrella. With this my temper got the best of me, but I was sorry for it. I then struck her, and she fell, and we both fell down, and she got up before me to check me not to hit her any more. At that time I could not see out of my eyes for tears, and she cried out, 'Oh, Jim Burton, I'm only trying you, for come on, and I will go home with you. Don't hit me any more.' I said, 'It is too late now, for I have not a home for myself,' and walked further up the line. I was blind at the time with passion, and I picked up a stone, and hit her with it, and she fell down in the same place where body was picked up. She said, 'Jim, don't, for that is my last; do come with me Jim.' Then after I had seen what I had done, I placed the stone upon her that was lying alongside her; then I was going to destroy myself beside her, for both of us to be picked up together, but the engine came down so quick on the top of me. I was so excited that I did not hear or see the engine till it was on top of me. When I got half way up the bank on the left-hand side through my being sick and bad, I slipped my foot and came down to the line again alongside of the engine. The enginemen were on the engine, and the engineer was looking up on the right-hand side towards my wife. I heard them say, 'It's a woman.' He could not do other but see me, for I was a long time getting up the bank. When I got up I said to myself, 'Poor thing, she is picked up;' and I laid down in the field, for I was so sick, and I had a hard struggle to get home, I was so bad. After I went into the town I bought threepennyworth of laudanum, and on Wednesday night I went and got ninepennyworth of laudanum at different shops, and I laid down in a truck beside the patent fuel, and expected to meet her in death, but I did not succeed, for my death hadn't to be at that time, for the Lord knew best, and I am very thankful that I did not lose my life then, or I would have been a lost sinner. I did not wish to live any longer when I found I had lost my best friend. The reason I kept this to myself was because I wanted to be laid beside her, and I hope all sisters and the doctors in Sunderland Infirmary, parents, brothers and sisters, also all inquiring friends will be satisfied with this my confession. I hope my poor father and mother no one will upcast this to you, as I was brought up with good parents, but I am now at that age at which parents have not much control. I hope her poor father, mother, brothers, and sisters will freely forgive me, as I have forgiven them, and I have no spite against anyone, for I am not only praying for myself, but for the one I am going to follow.—JAMES BURTON."

THE AFFRAY WITH A HOUSEBREAKER.

AT the Stratford Petty Sessions, on Saturday, George Smith, sixty, a stone sawyer, of 5, Bank Top, Bury, Lancashire, was charged on remand with breaking and entering the dewelling house, 6, Claremont-villas, Higham-hill, Walthamstow, the residence of William Searing, an independent gentleman, with intent to commit a felony therein, on the 1st instant; further with violently assaulting William Brackitt, of 5, Claremont-villas, by striking him on the face with a stone in a handkerchief, in order to prevent his lawful apprehension at Palmerston-road, Walthamstow. That was at about half-past eleven, and previous to his departure Mr. Searing asked him to keep an eye on the premises. Scarcely half an hour had elapsed when the witness went into his scullery, and while there he heard the smashing of glass. Going to the back of Mr. Searing's premises he saw the prisoner standing by the scullery window. There was a lot of broken glass scattered about, and a whole pane had been knocked out. On the hands of the prisoner was some blood. Witness said to the prisoner, "How's this?" and prisoner replied, "I heard a breaking of glass, and came here to see what was the matter." Witness then told prisoner that he must have a better explanation than that, as he was in charge of the house. He then questioned the man as to where he lived, and prisoner replied that he lived in Walthamstow, adding that it was in "Green-street." The prisoner was committed for trial at the Central Criminal Court.

TERRIBLE TRAGEDY AT WALTHAMSTOW.

[SUBJECT OF ILLUSTRATION.]

ON Wednesday evening the usually quiet neighbourhood of St. James's-street, Walthamstow, was thrown into a state of great excitement by the discovery that a blacksmith, named William Gouldstone, living at 8, Courtney-place, had murdered his five children. Gouldstone, it seems, is a blacksmith in the employ of a firm carrying on business in Upper Thames-street, City, and he has been engaged there for the last five years. On Wednesday evening he returned home earlier than usual, and, although he seemed to be in rather a strange temper, no danger whatever was apprehended. Mrs. Gouldstone had only given birth to twins a week since, and while a lodger in the house, who was acting as monthly nurse, was washing one of the babies, the father drowned his three sons—Frederick, aged sixteen months; Herbert, aged two and a half years; and Charles, aged three and a half years—in the cistern. He then went upstairs, and while in the bedroom alone with his wife, struck the two infants murderous blows with a hammer. The wife's screams brought assistance, when the murderer opened the door and said, "I have killed my children. I am a happy man now. Your other three children are in the cistern. I shall be hanged and you will be single. You wished them dead, and now they are." He then kissed his wife. Serjeant Smith, of the N Division, with some policemen, shortly after arrived on the scene, and removing the bodies of the three drowned children to the mortuary, they sent for a doctor, who pronounced that the infant twins were not dead, but it was only a question of time, for the injuries they had received were sure to cause their death. This proved to be true —one of the infants died an hour later, and the other succumbed during the night.

EXAMINATION OF THE MURDERER.

William Gouldstone, aged twenty-six, a blacksmith, residing at 8, Courtney-place, St. James's-street, Walthamstow, was brought up in custody at Stratford Police-court on Thursday, and charged with murdering his three children—Charles, aged three and a half years; Herbert, aged two and a half years; and Frederick, aged sixteen months—by putting them into a water-cistern, at his residence on the 8th inst. He was further charged with murdering his two infant children, aged seven days, by striking them on the head with a hammer at the same time and place.

The prisoner is a man standing not more than 5 ft. 4 in., fair, and with light air. When his case was called on he folded his arms over the dock, but, after being there for about two minutes, he was ordered out, some applicants for the transfer of a public-house licence having come late. When he returned he placed his hands together, and then rested his head on his right hand. He seemed careworn, and was continually looking about the court.

Ada Hamilton, wife of William Hamilton, was the first witness called. She said: I am a monthly nurse, and know the prisoner. He lives at 8, Courtney-place, St. James's-street. I have been acting as nurse to his wife, who was confined on last Wednesday week at night of twins, both male children, and I have been residing in the house as a lodger for the last ten weeks. There were three other children in the family—Charles Gouldstone, three years and a half old; Herbert Gouldstone, aged two years and a half; and Frederick Gouldstone, aged sixteen months. Last night, between five and six o'clock, I was in Mrs. Gouldstone's bedroom washing the two babies. I was in the act of washing them when prisoner came in from the street at about five o'clock or a quarter-past five. I heard him go into the kitchen. The two eldest children were at that time in the kitchen playing, and Freddy was in the bedroom with me. When I heard him come in I went to the kitchen just to see who it was, and I returned. I spoke to him, and said, "Oh! you did frighten me; I wondered who it was." He made no reply. I did not notice anything particular about him. I went back into the bedroom, and finished washing the babies, when he came in. This was ten minutes after he came indoors. He stood by his wife's bedstead, but he did not speak to her. She asked him, "How is it you are home so early?" He said, "I left the place while the manager had gone to dinner, and I came home." His wife then asked if he had told them at the shop about her being confined, and he said, "No;" with that he took the little boy Frederick off the bed, and went into the kitchen. [Here the witness began to cry.] When I had finished washing the first infant I went into the kitchen, leaving the twins by their mother's side. I went into the kitchen, and saw him sitting on the fire-guard, the three children playing on the floor. He had a piece of string in his hands. I have seen it since. It was similar to that produced by Inspector Foulkard. I asked him if he had had his tea, and he said, "No." I told him it was ready for him, and with that I went back to the bedroom, and washed the other baby. I put it into the bed by the side of the mother, and I then returned to the kitchen. I went to the washhouse and saw a chair by the cistern. The children, at this time, were still playing in the kitchen. The cistern was in the washhouse, up high. The prisoner was sitting on the fire-guard in the kitchen. Having noticed the chair under the cistern where a perambulator had stood, I asked who put it there, and the little boy Charlie said, "Daddy did." I again went back into the bedroom, and got Mrs. Gouldstone out of bed. I made her bed, and she got in again. Just at this time, as she was getting in, the prisoner came along the passage, and looked into the room. I said, "You can come in, Mr. Gouldstone." He made some answer—a mumbling noise—which I could not hear. With that I said to Mrs. Gouldstone, "Shall I leave the room a minute; perhaps Mr. Gouldstone wants to speak to you?" and she said, "Yes, do, my dear." With that I left the room and went downstairs. I heard the prisoner open the kitchen door—which was shut as I passed it—walk across the landing, and into the bedroom. I got to the yard door, when I heard screams of "Murder!" from the prisoner's wife. I ran upstairs and tried to open the door, she still crying "Murder!" inside. I could hear nobody speak but her. I heard her say, "Good God! he is murdering my children." I did not hear the cries of the children. Being unable to open the door, I called out, "Help!" three or four times, and the landlady of the house, who was in the yard, ran towards me. We both pushed the door to try to force it open, but could not do so. With that the prisoner opened the door. The prisoner's wife was still crying out. He opened the door, and I said, "Oh, you wicked man; what have you done?" Mrs. Gouldstone was standing at the foot of the bedstead. She said, "Come and look at my babies, and see if he has killed them." With that I passed into the room, and I saw the two babies lying on a pillow behind her. She was down at the foot, just where I had laid the babies. They were each bleeding from the nose and mouth, and one had got a bruise right over one of its eyes. They were both breathing. With that I covered a sheet over them. When I said, "Oh, you wicked man!" Mr. Gouldstone said, "No, I am not a wicked man. I am a happy man now. Your other three children are in the cistern." He said the latter to his wife. The prisoner then went into the kitchen. I stopped with his wife for a few seconds. Mrs. Gouldstone said, "He has killed the other three children; go and see." I went into the kitchen, and saw the prisoner coming in the kitchen door from the washhouse with the boy Frederick in his arms. He laid him on the floor. I turned back and saw his wife coming on to the landing. I ran back to her, as I did not want her to see the child. It seemed as if he had been in the water, and appeared to be dead. I was very much frightened. I went back to the prisoner's wife, and I did not leave her for ten minutes. When I went into the kitchen again I saw the three children lying on the ground, all of a row, side by side. They were swamped with water. By this time a gentleman (a chemist) was present. The prisoner was also in the kitchen at the time. He said nothing, and no one spoke to him. I saw a police-constable come afterwards, and saw the prisoner taken into custody. He and the policeman went into the bedroom, and his wife asked him to leave all the money he had, as she had the doctor to pay. Both the children were now dead. One died half an hour after, and the other two this morning. Witness did not hear the prisoner charged by the police. Prisoner said, "All the children are dead now. I shall be hanged, and you will be single. You wished them dead, and now they are." He then kissed his wife. I have lived in the house for ten or eleven weeks, and the prisoner has always lived on good terms with his wife; but I noticed he appeared strange after the twins were born. He was not unkind to the children; he seemed fond of them all; but he had not looked at the twins. The wife is now dangerously ill. The prisoner was remanded.

RE-EXAMINATION ON SATURDAY LAST.

The prisoner, William Gouldstone, was again brougt up at Stratford on Saturday morning. While in the cells of the court he was visited by two of his brothers. He seemed calm and perfectly unconcerned at his position.

When placed in the dock the prisoner immediately folded his arms and rested them on the front. He listened intently to the charge as read by Mr. Powell, the chairman. Mr. Atkinson appeared for the prisoner.

Mr. Wells, the clerk, read over the depositions of the witness Ada Hamilton, the nurse, during which the prisoner furtively glanced around alternately at the Bench, the reporters, and the people in the court, which was crowded. By and bye he leaned his full length as much as he could over the breadth of the dock, and again looked around, moving his feet, as if marking time with the clerk's reading of the depositions. When the constable produced the hammer it was found in a neck handkerchief, and the prisoner looked around, pointed to it, and then to his throat, as much as to say, "That is mine." The reading of the evidence was delayed a moment or so, while Colonel Howard, a justice, spoke to the chairman, after which Mr. Lister left the bench. The reading of the depositions was then proceeded with, the prisoner meantime watching the clerk intently, though instantly his attention was drawn to the body of the court. After about five minutes' absence Mr. Lister returned to the court and took his seat on the Bench, the prisoner glancing at him as he entered. When the hammer was produced, the nurse added to her evidence that it was not until the prisoner was taken into custody that she saw it. The constable asked her for it, and she went into the bedroom and found it behind the door, near the dressing-table. She noticed it, but saw no marks on it. She gave it to the constable.

Mr. Wells, the clerk, here had a short conversrtion with the Bench, and afterwards asked Inspector Craggs if he wanted a remand. He said yes, and the prisoner was remanded for a week to give the Treasury time to prosecute.

FURTHER PARTICULARS.

William Gouldstone, the murderer, was a man ordinarily by no means of the care-worn, roving-eyed description he presented in court. An uniform quietness of manner characterised him, and to all his surroundings he was a quiet, simple-minded, retiring man. Though twenty-six years of age, and rather stoutly built, he preserved a great deal of boyishness. He was not, according to description, a thoroughly illiterate man, who had no conversational ability. The young couple had been married four years and a half, but had only lived at Walthamstow for eleven months. They had the reputation of being as contented a couple as could be found, and Mr. Clark, their landlord, stated that it was only a day or two before he remarked to his wife how very fortunate they were in their present lodgers—a remark suggested by previous unsatisfactory experiences. Gouldstone showed, in a reserved sort of way, a disposition to be friendly with Clark, and they had been out for a Sunday morning walk on a few occasions. They would stroll along a good distance by the river, and only on one occasion entered a public-house together. Gouldstone always practised this strict abstemiousness, though he did drink beer. He did not smoke at all. On the Saturday previous to the tragedy he went to his beanfeast, but Mr. Clark says he saw him at ten o'clock at night quite sober. Despite the young family, the Gouldstones were never known to be in money difficulties, and they paid their rent with strict regularity. Gouldstone never spoke to anyone of his affairs, and his fellow-workmen at the wharf in Upper Thames-street knew little or nothing concerning him. Even in his friendly walks with Clark he never mentioned anything about himself. The walks were pursued with long intervals of silence, for if his companion started a conversation on any topic of the day Gouldstone would be out of his element, and was more at home in some little question of boyish games. All that could be learnt of Gouldstone's story is very simple. The son of a country farrier, somewhere in the district of Saffron Walden, he had been trained up in a branch of his father's business. On coming to London he obtained work at the Kirkley Wharf, 67, Upper Thames-street, and for a time lived in Bethnal-green, afterwards moving to Walthamstow. Gouldstone is believed to have one or two relatives in Walthamstow. His country origin was discovered through his aptitude in killing rabbits. Mr. Clark keeps these animals, and Gouldstone had often served him by killing one, and it was only last week he deposed of a mischevious doe. Gouldstone all the time he lived in Walthamstow came home regularly, and amused himself at home. He was a great amateur musician, playing the cornet, the flute, and other wind instruments. His conduct with his children was never boisterous or playful, and the landlord said his manner always seemed reserved even to them, though he was generally kind. Only one child, the eldest, could walk. They were rather weakly children, nothing sturdy. Gouldstone, in speaking of them, would always say, "There's my Charley," or "There's my Herbert," The children were not even noisy infants. From first to last there was nothing in the character of Gouldstone that would never have led to its being supposed for one instant he was capable of a crime almost unequalled in its cool and determined ferocity. His wife is described as "a good housewife and ladylike woman." They were, in fact, a very ordinary couple, little known to their neighbours, and studied their own affairs only. The few people that did know Gouldstone liked the man. He was, however, so little known in his own neighbourhood that when the news of the crime first spread, many a wrong man was mistaken for him. Of the regularity of Gouldstone's habits, and his apparently well-balanced mind, it is related that only on one accasion did he miss his train, the 6.4 a.m. from St. James's-street to Liverpool-street, and that was due to a clock going wrong. His landlord said he was as good as a timepiece. He continued in his own quiet way until the night the twins were born, but from that time became moody and discontented. When the nurse first announced to him the intelligence of the double birth, he gave one look of anger, said nothing, but put on his coat and hat and went straight out. On his return he made no remark, nor did he subsequently until after the murders. He would not look at the babies and never told anyone about them, but, left to himself, brooded and brooded until the fatal Wednesday. Despite the man's mania, it is to be feared there was only a too fiendish cunning in the deed. He chose his time and went home early on purpose, Mr. Clark ordinarily being first.

When the murderer was taken away by the police the poor wife, perhaps happily, lost consciousness for an hour; and through the night, which few thought she would survive, alternately broke into cries, to swoon away again. Two doctors have since been in attendance on her, but have administered no medicines, commanding in its stead a perfect quiet, and allowing nature to take its own course. They have been supplying her with jellies and light strengthening food. She asked and begged to see her dead little ones, but the doctors had to be stern in their refusal, dreading its effect on the sufferer's brain. Their chief fear now is that her reason will be affected by the terrible shock. She lies in a very low state. Some incautious people, with nothing but their own idle curiosity to satisfy, invaded the house and asked to see the poor woman, but of course were denied. The police, anticipating a crowd of sightseers, have volunteered a good body of their staff to keep the press back, but it is to be hoped their services will not be required, and respect will be had for the woman's dangerous condition.

The scene of the murder is a smart two-storeyed house, with a bay-windowed parlour. It is parallel with St. James's-street Railway-station. The part of Walthamstow in which it is situated is a thin, straggling neighbourhood, and the house, though one of the first of its row, has only been built two years.

THE GODIVA PROCESSION AT COVENTRY.

[SUBJECT OF ILLUSTRATION.]

IN spite of civic lukewarmness and threatening weather the septennial pageant of Lady Godiva's ride through the streets of Coventry passed off on Monday admirably. Except that at the start there was a considerable hitch, owing to the original but defective notions of the local saddler as to the quality of the material that stirrup-leathers should be made of, and the breaking, in consequence, of the fair equestrian's stirrup just as she was starting, the whole procession made its tour without mishap or impediment, thereby reflecting great credit on Captain Fitzgerald, who marshalled the lengthy cavalcade and controlled the programme.

Miss Maude Forrester, who impersonated the heroine of the day, "the grim earl's wife," arrived in the town the night before, and was much gratified, she told me, by her reception, though she seemed a little apprehensive in facing the ordeal she would have to go through. She expressed a hope that it would not rain—not, she added, "that she had much on to spoil." There was no nervousness apparent, however, when the time came, and very fortunately, for the horse that the gentle Countess had to climb on to stood nearly seventeen and a half hands, and was fidgetty besides, but in other respects, as an equestrian spectacle, of generous amplitude and sufficing comeliness, the horse and its rider were all that could be desired. At about half-past nine the pageant began to muster in St. Mary's Hall, one of the most historic chambers of the kingdom, but never probably so outrageously "historic" as on Monday, for there, in that noble room, with its priceless tapestries and venerable relics of five centuries, collected, on this memorable Bank Holiday, such a miscellaneous assortment of monarchs and notables as defied chronology, and would have sent Mrs. Markham mad.

The day's programme, it should be noted, consisted of two parts, the historical and the industrial; and, while the actors in the former were qualifying for their exalted impersonations in St. Mary's Hall, the latter were arranging themselves at their different rendezvous, and concentrating on the Pool Meadow. All the fun, of course, was with the kings and queens. As I entered the Hall I found a weaver in a somewhat excited state expostulating with the secretary. He had been told off for Richard II., but thought it was Richard III., and, happening to refer to history he found that that monarch was reported to be somewhat deformed in person. "No, sir," said he, "I won't have a hump on my back!" But his mistake was explained to him, and the weaver was pacified, and though he had grey whiskers of conspicuous length, he proceeded complacently to equip himself for the part of the young prince who was cut off in the flower of his manhood, and accounted by his contemporaries (when last seen by them) a model of personal elegance. Hearing a stir outside I went into the street, and found that the good-natured crowd, waiting for Lady Godiva to arrive, had mistaken for that personage a carriage in which sat a very quiet wedding party. That is to say, they had intended to be very quiet. They had evidently conspired, happy souls, just to slip away and be married as they were, but, absorbed in their own affairs, they had forgotten that their church was in the very thick of the Bank Holiday pageant. So the quiet wedding was very merrily frustrated, and the bride, all blushes and brown silk, was handed out by a nervous parent, in sight of an assembled multitude. And then came the gentle bridesmaids just as the sightseers had got breath again for another cheer, and the mellow bells of Trinity rang out their musical peal; and while all Coventry was waiting outside in the sunlight to see "the Lady" pass, those five were all alone in the shady chancel of the beautiful minster, entering upon or witnessing the life-long contract "for better or for worse." Then, on a sudden, came the rattle of wheels again on the cobble-stone road, and the Lady Godiva—or "Maudiva," as the wags had it—stepped from her brougham. "Then fled she to her inmost bower," and while in secrecy she "unclasped the wedded eagles, the grim earl's gift," I returned to the Hall to see Royalty taking form.

Much had transpired there during my absence. Edward the Black Prince ("so called from the colour of his armour," as the playbill stated) was seated, in a dejected attitude and a suit of recently varnished panoply, upon a side bench, gazing with a forlorn aspect on a sable helm, solemn with three funereal plumes, which he confided to me was three sizes too big for him. Richard II., now in full Royal style, was striding about the Hall, with his crimson mantle free-flowing behind him, but keeping a watchful eye the while upon his crown, which lay on a chair close by, lest some rascally Lancastrian should filch it. For Henry IV. was on the next seat engaged in helping William Shakespeare, "dramatist and poet," to strap up Falstaff's voluminous person. In another group Leofric, Earl of Mercia, the husband of the beauteous countess "who took the tax away and built herself an everlasting name," was exchanging counsel with Henry VIII. The former wanted some material to stuff his calves—"and his shoes, too," added the light-hearted monarch—while the latter had not been able to find among the properties provided the exact kind of hat which he considered his prerogative. "Take this," said Leofric, handing him the scholastic head-covering of Sir William Dugdale, which happened to be lying near him unguarded. "Mercia! pad your shoes!" retorted the indignant Tudor, severely, "and pull up your stockings." Up in one corner, with truly heroic fortitude, St. George was transferring himself from loosely-fitting corduroys into a suit of silver scales that fitted him like a fish's skin, while Henry VI. was holding forth to some pages in pink and gold as to the extraordinary character of the garments that the upper classes wore in the fifteenth century. "I think," ventured one of the pages in explanation, "you've got the breeches on wrong side foremost!" And so it proved. The Red Rose had reversed his garments, and yet wondered exceedingly at their inappropriate bagginess. It was a complete wilderness of kings.

But time was passing. The melancholy Black Prince, overcome by the gloom of his armour, was becoming visibly more dejected as the hour of the start approached, and insisted on having a very quiet horse to ride. Bluff King Hal, having had to restore Dugdale's collegiate cap, was wandering about in despair and a soft felt hat, looking for a becoming substitute. Richard II., elate with ermined splendour, rallied the Patron Saint of England. "I think you've got a fly on your coat," said he. "I beg your pardon: it's a dragon." Sir Thomas White, Lord Mayor of London in 1553, was hoping to the Earl of Mercia that there would be "a drop of good ale" before they started. But whatever their private feelings, all were alike waiting for the summons to the procession, and very soon the news got abroad, "She's coming, she's coming!" And quietly, out of a low arched doorway of immemorial oak, all heavily bossed with iron, there stepped the Lady of the Day, swathed in a long black satin robe. "The deep air listened round her," as she moved from under the shadow of the old minstrel gallery, and down the stairs into the cloisters by the courtyard. The photographer, however, was not ready for her. He was engaged with "some kings." So Lady Godiva retired to the mayor's room to wait her time. Meanwhile the scene in the yard had brightened into a wonderful realism. Forget that a camera stood in one corner with a group of nineteenth-century men about it, and see only that splendid relic of the past, the yard and porch of St. Mary's Hall, filled with horses caparisoned as befitted the steeds of kings and nobles, with attendants in brilliant liveries moving about, a monarch or two standing by his horse; the gallery filled with pages in their silks and satins, laughing with the ladies who were in waiting upon the queens; a flag in one corner flapping bravely, the sun shining brightly, and, over all, the bells of St. Michael's pouring out their matchless music upon the breeze. For a minute or two the beauty of the *mise-en scene* quite threw common sense off its balance, but the grotesque anachronism of the assemblage and the positive absurdity of some of the personalities soon asserted itself. St. George was leaning out of a side casement, waiting till the Jester and Henry VIII. had finished with the beer-jug which they were merrily discussing, while Falstaff, swaggering across the court, was called to order for intercepting the line of the photographer's vision of a group of pages.

Then there is a rustle of dresses, and out from a doorway of the fourteenth century step Queen Elizabeth, Margaret of Anjou, and Mary Queen of Scots, with their bonny retinues of little maids in waiting. The photographer is hard at work taking character after character, when the bells chime the hour, eleven. It is time for the procession to start already, if the programme is to be fulfilled. So the word to hurry is passed round, and then ensues such a scene of horse-mounting as Coventry probably never saw before. Sir John has to be hoisted into a saddle by a policeman and a beadle, assisted by the Black Prince and several civilians, and, though thus abundantly aided, very nearly succeeds in falling off on the other side. Then the Black Prince himself, anguish depicted upon his countenance, is elevated perpendicularly into the air and brought down astride and stiff across his horse, and as he alights so he remains, moody, rigid, black.

Throughout the line of march the streets were decorated with flags, and not only the pavements but the windows and balconies were crowded with sightseers.

That the representation as a whole was abundantly creditable to the public spirit of the comparatively few who organised it is beyond doubt, and putting on one side all contention as to whether the tradition of "the woman of a thousand summers back" has any foundation in fact or not, and disregarding the mouldy indignation of the alleged posterity of Leofric Earl of Mercia, there can be no question but that the good people or Coventry provided a very bright holiday for the town and country round, and that the taste and arrangement of the pageant did full justice to the beauty of the legend that "the city of the three tall spires" delights to believe in and to perpetuate.

The secretary said he regretted the absence of Jumbo from the show, for, said he, "Our arms are an elephant and castle; we have got a castle, but could not manage the elephant." But I do not think he had any cause for regret. Jumbo would of course have been another local feature, but there was enough without him to constitute an excellent and entertaining chronicle of the great personages and great events of the city's history.

PHILLIP REES, twenty-four, clerk, was charged on remand, on Monday, at the Greenwich Police-court, with throwing stones in the neighbourhood of the Salvation Army Barracks at Lewisham. The facts of the case have been reported. The defendant stoutly denied the charge, but evidence was given by two or three witnesses, who swore positively to seeing the prisoner throw stones. Mr. Balguy imposed a fine of 20s.

ON Saturday morning Mrs. Weldon attended before Mr. Flowers and applied for a summons against Dr. Forbes Winslow upon the allegation that he had libelled her by stating that she was insane. Mrs. Weldon entered into a lengthy argument with Mr. Flowers, and during the course of his observations the learned magistrate said that there was no reason for believing that Dr. Winslow had acted in any other way than in the exercise of his profession by signing a certificate, and that could not be considered libellous. Mrs. Weldon said she was anxious to let everybody know that she was in her right mind. Mr. Flowers said no one doubted that. He refused to grant the summons, and said that if Mrs. Weldon considered that he was wrong she could apply to a higher court, and if she satisfied the court an order would be granted to compel the issue of a summons.

15,793 CURES ASTHMA, CONSUMPTION, AND DISORDERS OF THE THROAT AND LUNGS, RHEUMATICA, HYSTERICAL, NERVOUS AND HEART COMPLAINTS BY DR. LOCOCK'S PULMONIC WAFERS HAVE BEEN PUBLISHED IN THE LAST 12 MONTHS.—The benefit to society which has resulted from the discovery of this medicine is, however, far greater than these figures show, as many thousands of cures are effected and not made public. Dr. Locock's Wafers are sold by every medicine dealer in boxes at prices from 1s. 1½d. to 11s., so as to meet the circumstances of all ranks. Be careful to see the name in the Government Stamp.

Items of News.

ON Monday, at the Worship-street Police-court, Robert Mason, twenty-five, costermonger, was charged with having attempted to steal from the person, under the following circumstances. Police-constable 211 H deposed that shortly after midnight on Saturday he, while in company with another constable on duty in Shoreditch, saw the prisoner supporting a man who was intoxicated. The prisoner put him on a door-step, and while holding him with one hand was searching his pockets with the other. Witness took hold of the prisoner, and questioned the drunken man, who said that the prisoner was a stranger to him, and was trying to rob him. He added that the prisoner had seen him change a half-sovereign, and thought he had got the money in his pocket, but he had kept it in his hand. The constable added that the prosecutor was in the passage of the court, but again the worse for drink, so that he was not fit to appear in court. The prisoner simply denied the story told by the constable, but was forthwith sentenced to three months' hard labour as a rogue and vagabond. He exclaimed: "Well, that's nice; on the word of one policeman, and no prosecutor."

At the Southwark Police-court, on Monday, John Welch, aged sixteen, residing in Bermondsey, was charged with assaulting Hester Simmons, by striking her in the eye with his fist, and also assaulting Police-constable 289 M, by biting him on the hands. Hester Simmons stated that on Saturday night last, about half-past eleven o'clock, she was quarrelling with Mrs. Welch, when the prisoner struck her a violent blow in the eye, blackening it considerably. She at once fetched Police-constable 289 M, and gave the prisoner into custody. On the way to the station the prisoner was very violent, tried to kick the constable, and bit him severely on the hand. The magistrate remanded the prisoner.

On Monday, at Bow-street Police-court, a young man named James Feeley was charged with attempted burglary. About two o'clock on Sunday morning Police-constable 290 E was on duty in Mecklenburg-square, and found the prisoner secreted in the area of No. 45. When asked what he was doing there he said, "Oh, it's all right," and then made an attempt to escape. He rushed upon the area steps, and endeavoured to leap over the iron railings into the street. The constable, however, secured him, and took him to the Hunter-street Police-station. The premises were subsequently examined, and it was found that an attempt had been made to break into the house by cutting the doorpost away near to where the lock was affixed to the kitchen door. The prisoner was committed for trial.

William Tilley was charged at the Marlborough-street Police-court, on Monday, with stealing a purse containing a sovereign from the pocket of Catherine Ward, servant, 21A, Soho-square. The prosecutrix stated that on Monday last she was crossing Oxford-street, from Crown-street to Tottenham-court-road, a Salvation Army procession passing at the time, and while she was putting a postage stamp on an envelope the prisoner took her purse from her pocket, and ran away. On Sunday morning she saw the prisoner with others at the police-station, and picked him out as the person who had taken her purse. The prisoner said he would admit taking the purse. Police-constable John Holt, 118 C, proved picking up the purse, which the prisoner dropped. Mr. Mansfield committed the prisoner for two months with hard labour.

Mr. Hadley's flour mills at Sharpness-on-Severn were entirely destroyed by fire on Saturday night. The damage amounts to ten thousand pounds. The mill had just been re-fitted with new web machinery.

Joseph Richards, army pensioner, New John-street West, Birmingham, attempted to commit suicide on Sunday. After having dinner he went upstairs, and resting himself in front of the looking-glass, cut his throat. He inflicted a dangerous wound, and his recovery is regarded as hopeless. On the previous day he was discharged from his situation, and this is supposed to have preyed on his mind.

John Flynn, seventeen, was charged, at the Westminster Police-court, with being on enclosed premises for the supposed purpose of committing a felony. The prisoner was found concealed early on Saturday morning in an outhouse at the back of 29, Strutton-ground, Westminster, a jeweller's shop in the occupation of Mr. George Hughes. Another man with the prisoner escaped by climbing over a wall, and the latter when dragged from his hiding-place feigned drunkenness. Sergeant Preston said that the prisoner, who had been previously convicted, was the associate and trainer of thieves, and Mr. D'Eyncourt sentenced him to three months' imprisonment with hard labour.

On Saturday, at the Marylebone Police-court, a young man named John Bettie, a portmanteau maker, was charged with assaulting Blanche Widgeon, a married woman, by kissing her. Police-constable Hutchings, 407 X, said he was on duty in the Ledbury-road at one o'clock that morning, when Mrs. Widgeon came up to him, and said she had been insulted by the prisoner, who had kissed her. In his defence the prisoner said: I am truly sorry for what I did, and am willing to make the most abject apology to the lady. I know it was wrong to kiss her, but I was under the influence of liquor, or I should not have dreamed of doing it. Mr. Cooke fined him 20s., or in default ten days' imprisonment with hard labour. The prisoner, having stated that he had not sufficient money to pay the fine, was removed to the cells.

On Saturday Annie Tobin, aged eleven, of 118, Brunswick-road, Bromley-by-Bow, was admitted to the Poplar Hospital. She was blowing out a paraffin lamp on the night before, when it exploded, and being spilled over her clothes, she was terribly burnt about the body before the flame could be extinguished.—The Westminster coroner issued his warrant on Saturday for holding an inquest on the body of Lilly Cleaver, a girl eighteen years of age, of 35, Tachbrook-street. On Monday a lamp exploded and burnt the deceased so severely that she died on Friday in Westminster Hospital.—On Saturday Thomas White, aged sixteen, residing at 16, Neeld-terrace, Harrow-road, was conveyed to St. Mary's Hospital, having been severely burnt about the face and hands by the explosion of a methylated spirit lamp.

George Cox was charged at the Wandsworth Police-court with disturbing Mr. Edward Frederick Lane, of Somerset Cottage, Garrick-lane, Wandsworth. The complainant said the prisoner had been in his service as gardener, and was also engaged to look after his pony and trap. At three o'clock that morning he returned home drunk, knocked at the door, and created a disturbance. The prisoner said he went there as sober as a judge. Mr. Paget: Sober or not, that was not the time to perform your work. The prisoner said he had no other place to go to. Mr. Paget fined him 40s., with the alternative of fourteen days' imprisonment.

On Saturday the Dutch pilot cutter Vlissingen put into Dover, having sustained damage by striking the rocks at Copt Point, near Folkestone, the previous night. There was a strong wind at the time, and the vessel had a large number of pilots on board besides her crew. At low water the point, except to those familiar with the nature of the coast, is very dangerous, the rocks running out to sea for a considerable distance from the shore. Fortunately, the vessel struck the rocks in such a position that she managed to clear them at once, or the consequences might have been very serious.

A silversmith named Matthew Salt was charged, at Clerkenwell Police-court, on Saturday, with causing serious injuries to his wife by setting her clothing on fire. The accused, who denied the charge, was remanded. Later in the day Mr. Barstow, the presiding magistrate, was informed that the unfortunate woman was in a very critical condition, and her depositions were subsequently taken, from which it appeared that she was unable to state how her clothing became ignited.

At the Worship-street Police-court, on Monday, Mary Tinkley, aged thirty-five, was charged with refusing her task of work while an inmate of the Bethnal-green Workhouse, and also with breaking several panes of glass, the property of the guardians. The labour-master of the workhouse deposed that the prisoner was a "casual inmate," admitted as a casual, but under the Act was to be kept in the workhouse for three days, during which she was to do certain work. On Saturday he took her two pounds of oakum as her task, but when it was given to her she refused to touch it and said that she wanted to go out. He left her and subsequently heard a smash of glass. On going into the workroom he found the prisoner with a tin pannikin in her hand—the tin having been left for drinking purposes—she was given into custody. In answer to the magistrate, Mr. Bushby, the prisoner said she could not do the work because she was suffering from sores on her shoulders caused by a skin affection. She asked to see the doctor, who was brought afterwards, but he never examined her, only took her name, and said she would get some medicine at night. She was unable to work. The labour-master said that the prisoner was supplied with ointment, and the doctor certified that she was able to do the work, but she would not attempt it. The prisoner said that the labour-master told her he did not care whether she did it or not, and when she said she would break the windows, he told her to do it, as there were plenty of glaziers in the workhouse. Mr. Bushby said that was a preposterous story, and he thought the prisoner had overdone her defence. He believed she was an artful woman, telling a pitiful tale to excite sympathy. He therefore sentenced her to a month's imprisonment. The prisoner thanked the magistrate, saying, "I shall get rest and peace now;" and then, turning to the labour-master, called him "a thorough vagabond."

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